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Case No. EC-2002-01038
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From: Ann M Schmidt <ann.schmidt@enron.com>
Sent: Mon, 2 Apr 2001 01:29:00 -0700 (PDT)
To: Ann M Schmidt <ann.schmidt@enron.com>
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Fortune 500: The Story of American Business
Fortune, April 2001

Broadband's Chicken-and-Egg Bind --- What's Delaying Web's Promise? Media World Cites Networks, Networks Cite Lack of Media
The Wall Street Journal, 04/02/01

CAPITOL JOURNAL
California and the West Lockyer Prefers Action Over Talk in Power Crisis
Los Angeles Times, 04/02/01

Energy Prices Power Firms Higher on Fortune 500 Revenue: After 15 years, General Motors was driven from the top spot by oil giant Exxon Mobil.
Los Angeles Times, 04/02/01

General Motors driven from top spot of Fortune 500 by Exxon
Associated Press Newswires, 04/02/01

Exxon Mobil overtakes GM on Fortune list Oil giant rides higher energy prices to top of annual ranking based on revenue
The Globe and Mail, 04/02/01

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Saudi Arabia Seen Signing Gas MOUs In May -Sources
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Rate cuts tied to this week's data: If NAPM falls today, Fed may drop rates before next meeting
National Post, 04/02/01

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Asia Pulse, 04/02/01

India: Law Ministry hedges on Enron issue
Business Line (The Hindu), 04/02/01

Second thoughts on the Tehelka tapes

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Texas companies on the Fortune 500 list
Houston Chronicle, 04/02/01

Campaign funds are a regularly milked cash cow
Houston Chronicle, 04/02/01

Fortune 500: The Story of American Business
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Broadband's Chicken-and-Egg Bind --- What's Delaying Web's Promise? Media World Cites Networks, Networks Cite Lack of Media
By Jared Sandberg
Staff Reporter of The Wall Street Journal

04/02/2001
The Wall Street Journal
B1
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IT WAS HAILED as the ultimate bricks, clicks and flicks strategy.
Last year, video-rental giant Blockbuster Inc. and Enron Corp. joined forces on a plan to give consumers whatever entertainment they want, whenever they want it, right in their living rooms. Using Enron's high-speed "broadband" connections, Blockbuster would serve up a menu of movies and eventually games and music to TV sets. The companies were so confident in each other that they entered into an unusual 20-year exclusive agreement.
It lasted just eight months. A few weeks ago the companies decided to part ways, each dissatisfied with the other. Enron, a Houston energy company, complained that Blockbuster's online catalog of movies, which totaled only 100, was too thin. Blockbuster, a unit of Viacom Inc., complained that Enron 's technology was glitchy. Though it was supposed to be an accelerated rollout to millions of people, the service, tested in four cities, had just 800 users.
Those aren't the only fingers being pointed in the broadband marketplace these days. In many ways the promising technology is stuck in a chicken-and-egg dilemma: Media companies, which have closed many of their costly Internet efforts, are waiting for a much bigger audience; the six million or so residential broadband customers don't yet justify major

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investments in services that take advantage of the faster lines, they say. But without new broadband services along the lines of video-on-demand and Napster, cable and phone companies say they may have a hard time selling the high-speed lines beyond the early technology adopters. It's a quandary that has faced other technologies in their infancy such as radio and TV: Which comes first, the audience or the programming?

Even when the economy was booming, the high cost of upgrading cable and phone lines to broadband speeds made it challenging for the infrastructure operators to make money. Now, many fear the languid economy and rampant belt-tightening among corporations will decelerate the already-delayed deployment of broadband lines and hamper development of new programming and applications.

Last week's collapse of the broadband service of NorthPoint Communications Inc., which left more than 100,000 users scrambling for a new service provider, is emblematic of the industry's troubles. "It's going to be more of a sinkhole for many companies," says Blockbuster Chairman John Antioco, who in a recent speech to high-tech executives said: "There's tens of billions of dollars here. It's just on the wrong side of the ledger."

Yet no one thinks the long-promised broadband market is doomed. Cable and phone companies still are struggling to meet heavy demand from consumers for speedy connections, which include digital subscriber lines (DSL) and cable modems.

But the limping rollout of broadband connections, due in part to technical glitches, is holding up many corners of the high-tech industry. Higher bandwidth was supposed to make online shopping, entertainment and advertising more compelling. Wall Street analysts, research firms and high-tech executives predicted a cyclonic roll-out of zippy residential links a few years ago, forecasting as many as "tens of millions" of users in short order. Commercials continue to perpetuate the myth of ubiquitous broadband; Qwest Communications International Inc., for example, runs an ad that promises to deliver "every movie ever made" to a motel room. Though the company's network can assist in such a service, a spokeswoman concedes that it isn't available yet.

As broadband access companies struggle to roll out fast pipes, some content and technology companies have scrambled to survive. Numerous start-ups that hoped to make money through advertising, such as online show producer Pseudo, have gone under. Others, such as Cidera Inc., Laurel, Md., which specializes in delivering broadband content such as video, had to take a step backward by acquiring a news and information business that serves the much larger audience of dial-up Internet users.

The same waning patience of investors has affected established media